



PTH 6131: Exercise Prescription & Nutrition

Spring 2026

In Person

Lab:

Tues (Section 02) – 8:30 am – 10:30 am

Thurs (Section 01) – 8:30 am – 10:30 am

Locations: Morgridge Lab & All-Well North

Lecture:

Friday (All sections) – 10 am – 11:45 am

Location: SRH 114

Course Information:

Semester: Spring 2026

Credit Hours: 3

Semester Clock Hours: 75

Weekly Clock Hours: 5

Instructors:

Primary Instructor: Kelly B. Legacy, DPT, ATC

Office: SRH 202

Email: kmlegacy@plymouth.edu

Office hours: Wednesdays 11:30 am – 2:30 pm, and by appointment

Lab Co-Instructor:

Cheryl Coker, PhD

Office SRH 204

Email:

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Teaching Assistant:

Name: Connor Belt, SPT CO2027

Email: Connor.Belt@plymouth.edu

Office hours: TBD

Pre-Requisites: PTH 6111, PTH 6110, PTH 6120, PTH 6122, PTH 6124, PTH 6125, PTH 6126

Co Requisites: PTH 6130, PTH 6133, PTH 6132, PTH 6135, PTH 6136

Course Description: Covers principles of exercise prescription and nutrition for healthy individuals and for people with stable, well controlled chronic conditions. Emphasizes designing safe, effective exercise and nutrition plans when chronic conditions are either not functionally limiting or are not expected to be reversed through rehabilitation alone.

Student Learning Outcomes: At the end of this course the student will be able to:

1. Compare and contrast diets for health, fitness, and wellness across the lifespan. (7A)
2. Examine the health, wellness, therapeutic and fitness effects of diets (including any supplements). (7A)
3. Describe the measurement principles and accuracy of common methods to measure body composition. (7A)
4. Demonstrate the use of causal reasoning, deductive, inductive and abductive inference in using the best evidence to guide

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- client examination, evaluation and exercise prescription. (7A, 7D27)
5. Compare and contrast fitness goals for: 1. Primary and secondary prevention; 2. Improving high level performance; and 3. Improving performance in basic and instrumental activities of daily living (ADLs). (7A)
 6. Determine safe and effective exercise programs to achieve desired outcomes and goals. (7D27)
 7. Implement cardiorespiratory exercise prescriptions using the FITT principle (frequency, intensity, time, and type) for apparently healthy participants based on current health status, fitness goals and availability of time. (7D27)
 8. Implement exercise prescriptions using the FITT principle (frequency, intensity, time, and type) for flexibility, muscular strength, and muscular endurance for apparently healthy participants based on current health status, fitness goals and availability of time. (7D27)
 9. Establish exercise progression guidelines for resistance, aerobic and flexibility activity to achieve the goals of apparently healthy participants. (7D27, 30)
 10. Describe the procedures for, and the advantages and disadvantages of maximal and submaximal exercise tests. (7D19)
 11. Interpret exercise test results based on diagnostic criteria as well as functional capacity. (7A, 7D20)
 12. Prescribe and implement exercise programs for participants with stable and controlled chronic medical conditions (i.e. cardiac, pulmonary, metabolic, oncology, immune, endocrine, gastrointestinal, genitourinary, neurological). (7A, 7D27)
 13. Prescribe and implement exercise programs for healthy special populations (i.e., older adults, youth, pregnant women). (7A, 7D27)
 14. Optimize adoption of and adherence to exercise programs and other healthy behaviors by applying effective behavioral and motivational strategies. (7D23)
 15. Provide educational resources to support clients in the adoption and maintenance of healthy lifestyle behaviors. (7D23)
 16. Effectively educate others using teaching methods that are commensurate with the needs of the learner. (7D12)
 17. Demonstrate the ability to apply the basic concepts of physiology to the analysis of patient/client problems related to the gastrointestinal system. (7A, 7C)

Required Materials:

- Garner G, Tatta J, eds. Integrative and Lifestyle Medicine in Physical Therapy. Minneapolis, MN: OPTP; 2022.
- Various applied readings & resources (*available in Canvas course page*)

Supplemental Materials:

- Liguori, G. ACSM's Guidelines for Exercise Testing and Prescription (11th ed.). Wolters Kluwer, 2021
(*helpful, but not required to purchase, we have a few copies available within the department*)

Description of teaching methods and learning experiences:

Weekly labs pair DPT students with live clients to practice real-time screening, fitness testing, exercise prescription, nutrition counseling, and lifestyle-medicine coaching aimed at general health, physical activity, and specific performance goals. Lectures and guided discussions provide the scientific and clinical framework for exercise testing, FITT-based prescription, nutrition/GI health, and behavior change across the lifespan and chronic conditions. Low-stakes quizzes and in-class activities reinforce key concepts and help students integrate lab experiences with broader course content.

Students engage in repeated, supervised 1:1 and small group client interactions where they plan, implement, and document assessments and interventions, receiving feedback on professionalism, communication, and documentation quality. Lifespan and chronic condition specific application tasks require students to adapt testing and prescription principles to diverse populations with stable, controlled medical conditions. A final client assessment and reflection experience allows students to synthesize baseline to final data, articulate FITT-based and lifestyle recommendations, and critically evaluate their own reasoning and teaching strategies for future clinical practice.

Graded Course Activities:

Lab Prep, Professionalism & Documentation	40%
Lifespan/Chronic Condition Application	30%
Quizzes	10%
Final Client Assessment Guidance & Reflection	20%

Lab Prep, Professionalism, & Documentation

Lab Prep, Professionalism, & Documentation assess students' readiness for each lab session, their conduct while working with

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CJ clients, and the quality of their written records. This portion of the grade includes brief pre-lab preparation activities, in-lab behaviors that reflect safety, respect, teamwork, and effective communication, and timely completion of clear, accurate documentation of assessments, test results, and exercise/nutrition plans in the required formats.

Lifespan/Chronic Condition Applications

Lifespan/Chronic Condition Applications evaluate students' ability to extend what they learn in lab to other populations across the lifespan and to individuals with stable, well-controlled chronic conditions. This grade is based on brief written or in-class assignments in which students adapt testing, exercise prescription, nutrition, and lifestyle recommendations for groups like older adults, youth, pregnant individuals, and people with common chronic diseases.

Quizzes

Quizzes measure understanding of key concepts in exercise testing, prescription, nutrition, and integrative lifestyle medicine covered in lectures and labs. Short online or in-class quizzes will focus on essential facts and applied reasoning and are intended to reinforce learning rather than add major time demands.

Final Client Assessment Guidance & Reflection

Final Client Assessment Guidance & Reflection evaluates how effectively students synthesize the semester's work with their assigned clients and articulate the next steps. This component includes the Group Final Testing Form (summarizing baseline, midpoint, and final fitness results plus FITT-based and lifestyle recommendations) and each student's brief individual reflection on test interpretation, program design decisions, behavior-change strategies, and how they would adapt their approach for other populations in future practice.

In the event of snow days during lab, DPT students will meet virtually with their assigned clients during the scheduled lab time. Remote activities will vary depending on the week, but may include subjective check-ins, home based monitoring, collaborative planning of upcoming in-person sessions, brief at home training plans, and PAT strategy discussions. These experiences are designed to maintain continuity of care, preserve client rapport, and support ongoing preparation for the PAT while achieving the same exercise prescription, nutrition, and lifestyle medicine objectives as in on-campus labs.

Student Evaluation/Grading:

A	94.0 – 100
A-	90.0 – 93.9
B+	87.0 – 89.9
B	83.0 – 86.9
B-	80.0 – 82.9
C+	77.0 – 79.9
C	73.0 – 76.9
F	below 73.0

Students are reminded that continuation in the program necessitates achieving an overall grade point average of 3.0 (B) or better. Grades below 2.0 (C) are not acceptable or counted toward the DPT degree. No more than 9 credits below 3.0 may be counted toward the DPT degree (grades of B-, C+, or C). Make-up examinations will be given only in specific cases of absence (documented absences). Circumstances that may warrant an absence should be discussed with the instructor before the scheduled time of the exam. Failure to notify the instructor as stated may result in a zero for the exam.

Professional Conduct: Students are reminded of the program expectation that they follow Professional Conduct, see the Student Handbook, Professional Conduct and Reasonable Professional Expectations for the process of handling violations, remediation and consequences.

OSHA: Students are expected to follow all departmental lab safety and OSHA aligned guidelines, including proper equipment use, safe spotting, infection control practices, and adherence to posted emergency procedures during all laboratory sessions.

Cell Phones: Personal cell phone use (including texting) is prohibited in class. Also, please respect your classmates by turning your phone to vibrate prior to class start time. Do not turn phones off as the University uses texts to relate emergency information.

Graduate Academic Policies: The DPT Program is a selective admissions cohort-structured program. Some Graduate Academic Policies may not be relevant to the program. Students should refer to the Doctor of Physical Therapy Program Handbook for specific information about Scheduling, Capstones, and Internships. The sections on Grading System and Academic Standing Policy do apply to DPT students: <https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/graduate-academic-policies/>

Fair Grading Policy: Fair and equitable grading reflects values to which all members of the Plymouth State community commit themselves. Grades are used to assess the relative extent to which students achieve course objectives in all for-credit courses at PSU. Academic freedom allows instructors to determine course objectives within the bounds of established curricula, and the means by which a student's mastery of those objectives will be evaluated; and evaluate the quality of work on individual exams or assignments. Information can be found at <https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/> under Fair Grading.

Student Support: Student Support Foundation (SSF) provides short-term emergency financial assistance and long-term student support. For more information, see: <https://campus.plymouth.edu/student-support-foundation/> Student Support Foundation also runs a food pantry, located in Belknap Hall. To learn more about SSF or access the food pantry, either via open hours or a private appointment, contact the SSF advisor, at psu-ssf@plymouth.edu.

Academic Dishonesty: Cheating and plagiarism are very serious forms of academic dishonesty. Any use of unauthorized assistance on exams, papers, homework assignments, or other course work constitutes cheating. Knowingly providing assistance during an exam or allowing other students to copy one's work is also a serious form of academic dishonesty. Plagiarism consists of submitting written work that has been developed wholly or partially by someone else. Submitting written work in which the ideas of others have been duplicated or even paraphrased without proper reference to the author is also a form of plagiarism. Also considered plagiarism is the acquisition of term papers or other assignments from another source and subsequent presentation of these materials as the student's own work. In addition, students may not use papers in more than one course without the permission of both instructors.

Any student suspected of academic dishonesty will be reported to the Program Director immediately. A full description of academic integrity, violations and procedures when a violation to academic integrity in a course is suspected can be found at: <https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/> under Academic Integrity.

Attendance Policy: Attendance is expected to all class sessions. Students are ultimately responsible for their attendance; however faculty will assess students Professional Expectations based, in part, on their attendance (See Student Evaluation/Grading). Students who miss class for any reason are responsible for the information and work missed. Students should speak with the professor before missing the scheduled class when able.

Campus Accessibility Policy: Plymouth State University is committed to providing students with documented disabilities equal access to all university programs and facilities. If you think you have a disability requiring accommodations, you should immediately contact Campus Accessibility Services (CAS) in Speare210 (535- 3300) to determine whether you are eligible for such accommodations. Academic accommodations will only be considered for students who have registered with CAS. If you have a Letter of Accommodation for this course from CAS, please provide the instructor with that information privately so that you and the instructor can review those accommodations: <https://campus.plymouth.edu/accessibility-services/>

LibGuide for Physical Therapy:

The Libguide for Physical Therapy is an information sharing platform created through a collaboration between the library and the DPT faculty that presents relevant resources to support students in the Physical Therapy program. Examples of information you will find include tutorials to better understand citing sources in APA and AMA style, resources on how to avoid plagiarism, quick access to relevant databases and interlibrary loan as well as a contact link to the programs' assigned librarian. To view the DPT Program Libguide go to <https://library.plymouth.edu/physical-therapy>

Diversity and Inclusivity Statement:

We consider this classroom to be a place where you will be treated with respect, and we welcome individuals of all ages, backgrounds, beliefs, ethnicities, genders, gender identities, gender expressions, national origins, religious affiliations, sexual
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orientations, ability - and other visible and non-visible differences. All members of this class are expected to contribute to a respectful, welcoming and inclusive environment for every other member of the class. See this web page for the Plymouth State University IDEA Center Inclusion, Diversity, Equity, and Access. <https://www.plymouth.edu/idea-center>

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Tentative Schedule – Spring 2026

Week	Tuesday Lab	Thursday Lab	Friday Lecture
Jan 20-23	Data Collection: Health History Taking Client Interview ACSM Preparticipation Screening Algorithm Wellness Screen	Orientation: Cardiovascular Hemodynamics (HR, RR, BP, O2 sats) Understanding Medication Usage Intro to NH Police PAT/ Explanation of procedures	Health Screening & Exercise Testing: • Populations Comparison • NH Police PAT standards • physical activity demands • foundational movement patterns
Jan 27 – 30	Baseline Testing: FMS Body composition Testing	Baseline Testing: Movement Prep & Flexibility Training NH PAT	Goals, Energy Systems, & DAM • Population Comparisons • Training Goals • GI physiology
Feb 3 - 6	Baseline Testing: Muscular Fitness Testing SMART Goals	Baseline Testing: CRF Testing SMART Goals	FITT Principle Prescriptions, Exercise Programming & Diet Basics: • Population Comparisons • Fueling Different Energy Systems • Fueling for Health
*Feb 10 – 13	Muscular Fitness ExRx & Nutrition	CRF ExRx & Nutrition	Warmup/Cool Down Basics: • Population Comparison • Training Specifics
Feb 17 - 20	Warm/ups & Cool Downs for Muscular Fitness Training	Warm/ups & Cool Downs for CRF Training	Core, Balance, and Injury Prevention in ExRx & Nutrition: • Population Comparison • Activity Specific Considerations
Feb 24 - 27	Anterior/Posterior Core Training w/Muscular Fitness Program	Lateral & Rotational Core Training w/CRF Program	Progressions, Regressions, Adaptations
Mar 3 – 6	Continue/Modify Muscular Fitness/Core workouts	Continue/Modify CRF/Core workouts	Home Programming/ Independent Training
Mar 10 - 13	Retest Day: Movement Prep & Flexibility Training NH PAT	Retest Day: FMS Body composition Testing	
Mar 17 - 20	Spring Break		
Mar 24 - 27	Retest: CRF Testing	Retest: Muscular Fitness	PRE & SAID Principles
Mar 31 - 3	CRF Progressions (PRE & SAID)	Muscular Fitness Progressions (PRE & SAID)	Performance Training, Peak & Taper Programming
April 7 - 10	Performance Training (CRF)	Performance Training (Muscular Fitness)	Health, Longevity, Adopting Lifestyle Wellness & Behavior Theories of Lifestyle Change
April 14 - 17	Performance Training (Peak – CRF))	Performance Training (Peak – Muscular Fitness)	Stress Management & Recovery
April 21 - 24	Program Tapers Retest: CRF Testing	Program Tapers Retest: Muscular Fitness	
April 28 - 1	Recovery Workouts	Recovery Workouts	
May 5 - 8	Final - Client Assessment NH PAT, Guidance, & Reflection		

